

NTANDOMODS ICT DIPLOMA

MONTH 6

Social Media for Business

Facebook, WhatsApp Business, Instagram & Digital Marketing

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Introduction

Social media is the most powerful free marketing tool available to any business in Zimbabwe. Most of your customers are already on Facebook, WhatsApp, and Instagram every day. If your business is not where your customers are, you are losing money.

This month teaches you how to use social media professionally to promote a business, attract customers, and make sales - without spending money on advertising (though we will cover paid ads too).

Learning Outcomes

- Create and manage a Facebook Business Page
- Set up and use WhatsApp Business
- Create a basic Instagram Business account
- Write effective social media posts
- Take and edit product photos using a smartphone
- Understand basic digital marketing principles
- Create a simple content calendar
- Handle customer enquiries on social media professionally

Unit 1: Facebook for Business

1.1 Facebook Page vs Personal Profile

A Facebook Business Page is different from your personal profile. Never use a personal profile for business.

Feature	Personal Profile	Business Page
Friends/Followers	5,000 limit	Unlimited
Insights/Analytics	No	Yes - see reach, engagement, demographics
Advertising	No	Yes - run paid ads
Professional look	No	Yes - logo, cover photo, business info
Multiple admins	No	Yes - add staff to manage the page

1.2 Creating a Facebook Business Page

1. Log into your personal Facebook account
2. Click the menu (three lines) and select 'Pages'
3. Click 'Create New Page'
4. Enter your business name
5. Select a category (e.g. Retail, Education, Electronics)
6. Add a description of your business (2-3 sentences)
7. Upload a profile picture (your logo or product photo)
8. Upload a cover photo (a banner showing your business, products, or location)
9. Add your contact details: phone, email, address, hours
10. Click Create and you are live!

1.3 What to Post

- Product photos with prices and descriptions
- Customer testimonials and reviews
- Behind-the-scenes content (you working, packing orders, etc.)

- Special offers and promotions
- Tips related to your industry
- Questions that encourage engagement (polls, 'which do you prefer?')

Posting Rules

1. Post at least 3-5 times per week (consistency is key)
2. Use clear, well-lit photos (no blurry or dark images)
3. Write short, punchy captions
4. Always include a call to action: 'DM to order', 'WhatsApp us', 'Visit our shop'
5. Reply to every comment and message within 1 hour if possible

Unit 2: WhatsApp Business

2.1 Why WhatsApp Business?

WhatsApp is the most used messaging app in Zimbabwe. WhatsApp Business is a free version designed for small businesses. It has features that the regular WhatsApp does not.

2.2 WhatsApp Business Features

Feature	What it Does
Business Profile	Shows your business name, address, hours, email, website
Catalog	Display your products with photos and prices inside WhatsApp
Quick Replies	Pre-written answers to common questions (save time)
Labels	Organise chats: 'New Customer', 'Paid', 'Pending', etc.
Away Messages	Auto-reply when you are not available
Greeting Messages	Auto-welcome new customers who message you for the first time
Broadcast Lists	

Send a message to many customers at once (they see it as a private message)
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2.3 Setting Up WhatsApp Business

1. Download 'WhatsApp Business' from Google Play Store or App Store (it is a separate app from regular WhatsApp)
2. Register with your business phone number
3. Enter your business name (cannot be changed easily later)
4. Set your profile picture (logo or shop front photo)
5. Go to Settings > Business Tools > Business Profile
6. Fill in: address, business hours, email, website
7. Set up your Catalog with at least 5 products

2.4 Best Practices

- Respond to messages within 30 minutes during business hours
- Use Quick Replies for common questions (pricing, location, hours)
- Update your Catalog whenever prices change
- Use Status updates like Instagram stories (products, offers, daily updates)
- Never spam customers with too many broadcast messages (maximum 2 per week)
- Always ask permission before adding someone to a group

Unit 3: Instagram for Business

3.1 Why Instagram?

Instagram is a visual platform - perfect for businesses that sell physical products. If you sell clothing, food, beauty products, electronics, or crafts, Instagram is where your customers browse.

3.2 Setting Up a Business Account

1. Download Instagram and create an account
2. Go to Settings > Account > Switch to Professional Account
3. Select 'Business'
4. Choose your category
5. Connect your Facebook Page (optional but recommended)
6. Add your contact details

3.3 Types of Instagram Content

Format	Best For	Tips
Feed Posts	Product photos, announcements	Use hashtags, high-quality images
Stories	Daily updates, polls, behind-the-scenes	Post 3-5 per day, use stickers
Reels	Short videos, tutorials, trending content	15-60 seconds, use trending audio
Carousel	Multiple photos, step-by-step guides	Up to 10 slides, educational content

3.4 Hashtags

Hashtags help people find your posts. Use 5-15 relevant hashtags per post.

- Location hashtags: #Harare #Bulawayo #Zimbabwe #ZimBusiness
- Industry hashtags: #ZimFashion #ZimFood #ZimTech
- General hashtags: #SmallBusiness #ShopLocal #MadeInZim
- Your own hashtag: #NtandoMods #ShopNtando

Unit 4: Digital Marketing Basics

4.1 The Content Calendar

A content calendar is a plan that tells you what to post, when to post, and on which platform. Without one, you will either post too much, too little, or forget entirely.

Sample Weekly Content Calendar

Day	Facebook	Instagram	WhatsApp
Mon	Product photo + price	Feed post: new stock	Status: new arrivals
Tue	Customer review/ testimonial	Story: behind the scenes	Broadcast: weekly offers
Wed	Tip or how-to post	Reel: product demo	Status: tip of the day
Thu	Special offer	Carousel: product features	Reply to enquiries
Fri	Engagement post (poll/question)	Story: weekend plans	Status: weekend hours
Sat	Weekend sale post	Feed post: happy customer	Broadcast: flash sale

4.2 Taking Good Product Photos

1. Use natural light (near a window, not direct sunlight)
2. Use a plain background (white wall, clean table)
3. Clean the product before photographing
4. Take photos from multiple angles
5. Hold the phone steady or use a stand
6. Edit brightness and contrast using the phone's built-in photo editor
7. Never use blurry or dark photos - they make your business look unprofessional

4.3 Writing Captions That Sell

- Start with a hook (question, bold statement, or emoji)
- Describe the product benefit - what problem does it solve?

- Include the price (customers hate asking 'how much?')
- End with a call to action: 'DM to order', 'Comment MINE below', 'Link in bio'

4.4 Handling Customer Enquiries

1. Reply as fast as possible (within 30 minutes ideally)
2. Be polite and professional at all times
3. Give clear, specific answers (pricing, availability, delivery options)
4. If you do not know the answer, say 'Let me check and get back to you' - then actually do it
5. Never argue with customers publicly - take it to private messages
6. Thank every customer for their interest, even if they do not buy

Month 6 Final Assessment

Theory (30 marks)

1. What is the difference between a Facebook personal profile and a Business Page? Name 3 differences. (6 marks)
2. List 4 features of WhatsApp Business that regular WhatsApp does not have. (8 marks)
3. What are hashtags and how do they help a business on Instagram? Give 3 examples of hashtags for a clothing shop in Harare. (6 marks)
4. Why is a content calendar important? What does it contain? (4 marks)
5. List 3 rules for taking good product photos. (6 marks)

Practical (70 marks)

1. Create a Facebook Business Page for a fictional or real small business. Include: logo, cover photo, business description, contact info, and 3 sample posts with images. (25 marks)
2. Set up a WhatsApp Business profile with: business info, greeting message, away message, and a catalog of at least 5 products with photos and prices. (20 marks)

3. Create a 1-week content calendar for a business using the template provided. Include posts for Facebook, Instagram, and WhatsApp. (15 marks)
4. Write 3 sample Instagram captions for products. Each must include a hook, description, price, and call to action. (10 marks)

Pass Mark: 60%

Congratulations!

If you have passed all 6 months, you have completed the NtandoMods ICT Diploma. You now have the digital skills to work in any modern office, run a small business online, or qualify for further education.

What You Can Now Do

- Operate a computer confidently
- Type at 20+ words per minute
- Create professional documents in Microsoft Word
- Build spreadsheets and use formulas in Microsoft Excel
- Design presentations in Microsoft PowerPoint
- Communicate professionally via email
- Use the internet safely for research
- Market a business using social media

Your Certificate

Your NtandoMods Certificate of Competency in ICT will be issued within 5 working days of passing all assessments. This certificate is recognised by employers across Zimbabwe.

Well done. Go and make it happen.

NtandoMods - Empowering Zimbabwe, one skill at a time.

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